



Nests

Some birds go to great lengths to make amazing-looking nests.



Tunnel home: some weaver birds build nests with tunnel entrances.



In the reeds: the reed warbler builds its nest between thin reeds.



Mud nest: the domed ovenbird makes its nest entirely out of mud.



Tree trunk: A blue tit has built this nest in a hollow tree trunk.

Ground eggs

Some birds don't make nests at all. Instead, they lay their eggs on the ground. These Eurasian oystercatchers' eggs are camouflaged against the pebbles.



The eggs are speckled and difficult to spot.

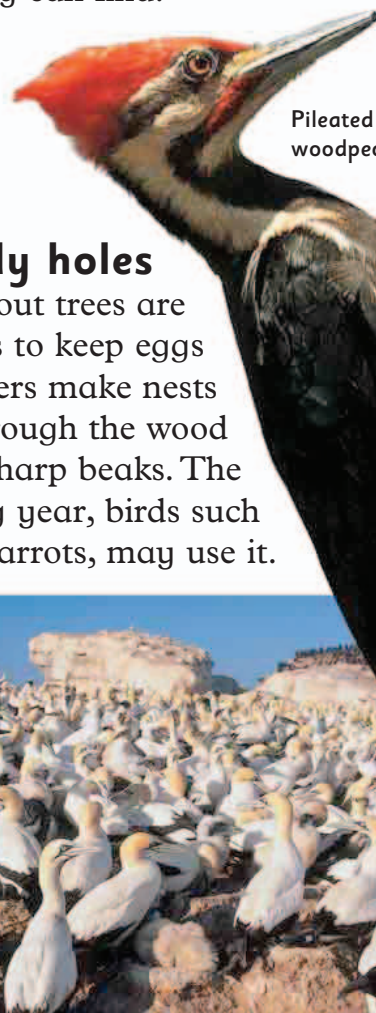
A perfect fit

Round, hollow nests like this are called cup nests. Birds build them in trees using twigs, feathers, moss, and anything else they can find.

When a bird has made its nest, it turns around and around in it until it has made a perfect hollow.

Handy holes

Hollowed-out trees are good places to keep eggs safe. Woodpeckers make nests by chiselling through the wood with their sharp beaks. The following year, birds such as parrots, may use it.



Pileated woodpecker



Safety in numbers

Along the west coast of Africa, thousands of cape gannets lay their eggs at the same time, right next to each other. This reduces the chances of the eggs being eaten.

Eggs

Birds' eggs come in a variety of sizes and colours.

Southern cassowary egg

